

Image 8.2: Pakistan ceded Shaksgam Valley to China
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

By the end of 1962, the overture to China began to make very important changes to the basic structure of Pakistan's diplomacy. Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, then Pakistan's Minister for Industries and shortly to be Foreign Minister, argued that Pakistan's alliance with the US, by means of membership of CENTO[4] and SEATO[5], had yielded no real dividends in terms of settling the Kashmir dispute in Pakistan's favour. US military aid to Pakistan had, in no way, been able to diminish the Indian hold over the valley. There appeared, therefore, an opportunity to play the China card against India. Such a move served directly to balance the depreciating value of Pakistan's American alliance. As Sino-Indian relations deteriorated, the US' inclination towards counting India as an anti-China nation, increased. It could not have escaped the notice of Ayub Khan and his advisors that relations with China could align India, if only tacitly, with the West. They should've also noticed that the US would do nothing to discourage such an alignment. Indeed, to woo India, it was quite possible that America would